JJAS 2026 rainfall outlook

ECMWF SEAS5 initialized 1 May 2026 · calibrated with CHIRPS v3.0 · JJAS R1+R2 rainfall domain

Research reconstruction — not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

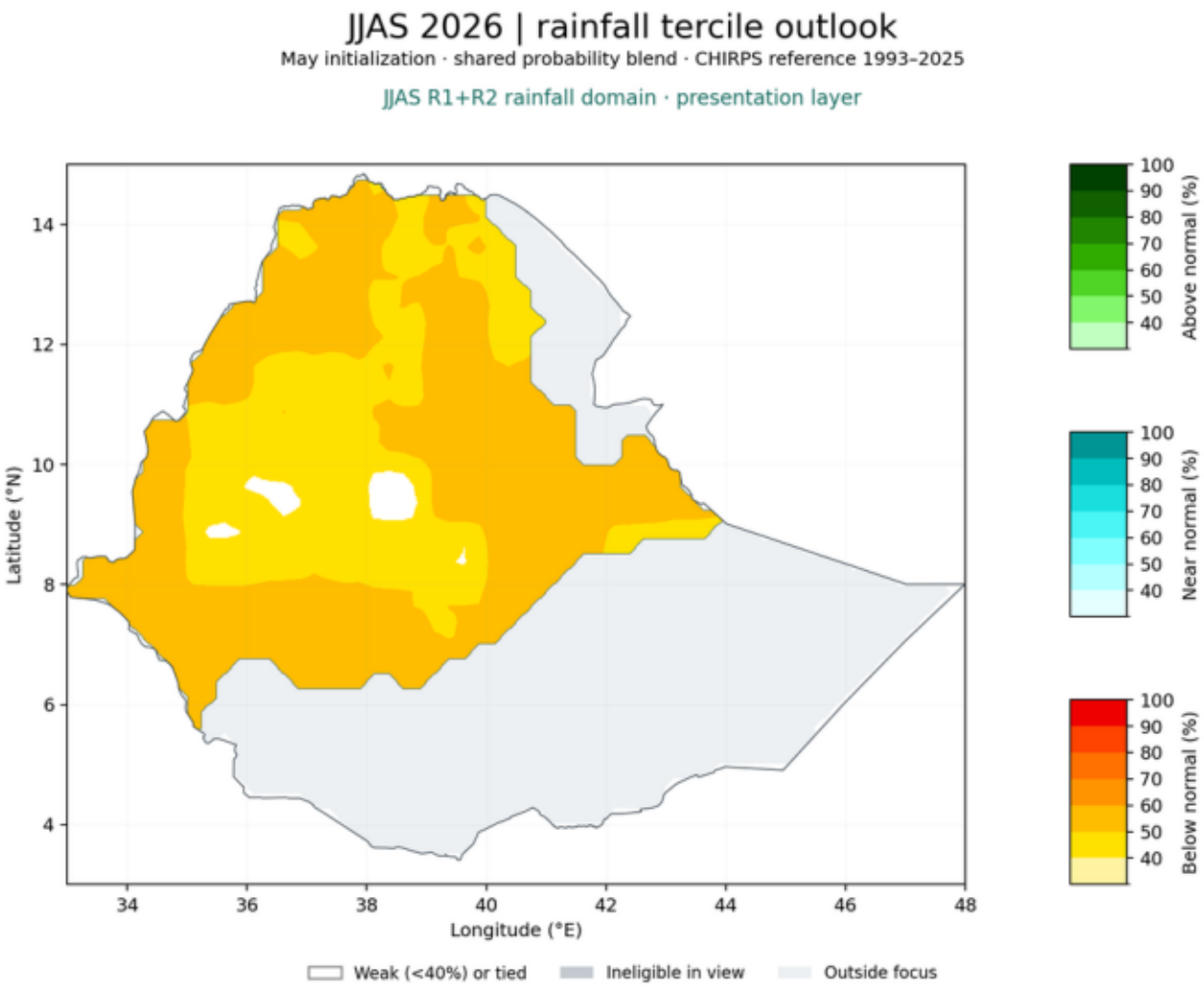
The forecast leans toward below normal rainfall in the JJAS R1+R2 rainfall domain: averaged over the area, the local probability of below normal is 51%, against about 33% for climatology. Mean forecast rainfall is 700 mm against a 1993–2025 average of 831 mm (−131 mm, −16%).

Below normal 51% **Near normal 27%** **Above normal 22%**

Average local probability: each grid cell has its own tercile probabilities; these are their averages over the 100% of the area that has probabilities, not the probability that the area-total rainfall falls in a category.

Forecast signal: Moderate tilt toward below normal (largest area-average probability compared with a one-third reference; based on probabilities only).

Historical skill (JJAS R1+R2 rainfall domain): Modest improvement over climatology (interval above zero). Probability skill (RPSS) +0.044, cross-validated 1993–2016, 95% interval +0.002 to +0.084; better than climatology in 17 of 24 years. A strong signal is not a confidence rating.



Display interpolation: 12×; Gaussian σ=0.6 native cells. Statistics and exported fields use the original 0.25° grid.
Research reconstruction of a May-initialized forecast; not an official EMI/ICPAC product.

All targets, evidence and record

JJAS 2026 — May initialization · JJAS R1+R2 rainfall domain

Target	Below/near/above	Coverage	Anomaly	Verification status
JJAS 2026	51% / 27% / 22%	100%	−131 mm	Awaiting CHIRPS: Sep 2026 file not found (checked 11 Oct 2026)
Jun 2026	39% / 32% / 29%	100%	−32 mm	Verification published
Jul 2026	43% / 30% / 27%	100%	−32 mm	Verification published
Aug 2026	45% / 29% / 27%	100%	−34 mm	Verification published
Sep 2026	39% / 31% / 30%	100%	−31 mm	Awaiting CHIRPS: Sep 2026 file not found (checked 11 Oct 2026)

Historical skill, cross-validated (probability skill, RPSS, with whole-year 95% interval)

Target	RPSS (95% interval)	Yrs better	Holm p	In words
JJAS	+0.044 (+0.002 to +0.084)	17/24	0.115	Modest improvement over climatology (interval above zero)
Jun	−0.001 (−0.035 to +0.027)	15/24	0.537	No demonstrated improvement over climatology
Jul	+0.031 (+0.004 to +0.058)	19/24	0.094	Modest improvement over climatology (interval above zero)
Aug	+0.011 (−0.006 to +0.027)	16/24	0.308	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
Sep	+0.006 (−0.012 to +0.024)	14/24	0.537	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain

Verification against CHIRPS (single season or month)

Target	RPSS	CRPSS	Bias	Forecast / observed anomaly	Observed below/near/above
Jun 2026	+0.144	+0.410	+19.9 mm	−32 / −52 mm	85% / 11% / 4%
Jul 2026	+0.177	+0.205	+40.9 mm	−32 / −73 mm	81% / 14% / 5%
Aug 2026	+0.289	+0.411	+23.6 mm	−34 / −58 mm	85% / 14% / 2%

Cycle record

Model initialization: 1 May 2026 · ECMWF SEAS5 (system 51), 51 members

Target period: 1 Jun 2026 – 30 Sep 2026

Forecast record: Frozen 10 Oct 2026. Recalibrated with CHIRPS v3.0 when its observations for Jun 2026–Aug 2026 were already available (the fit itself uses 1993–2025 only): a retrospective reconstruction, not a forecast frozen before its outcome (SHA-256 manifest)

Publication status: Research reconstruction: produced after the initialization date with the published method; not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

Reference period: CHIRPS v3.0 JJAS 1993–2025 (33 seasons)

Observations processed through: August 2026 (Jun, Jul, Aug)

CHIRPS archive: Official CHIRPS v3.0 monthly listing checked 11 Oct 2026: monthly files through Aug 2026

Verification last run: 10 Oct 2026

Method / version: Shared climatology blend (λ = 0.59 for JJAS) · code 1287490

How to read: terciles split the reference-period rainfall into three equally likely parts. Climatology assigns about one-third to each (the observed tercile frequencies of the training years). Skill scores are decimals: +0.05 means a 5% lower score than climatology. RPSS refers to the blended probabilities; CRPSS and bias to the amount-corrected ensemble.

Limitations: few evaluation years and single verification seasons give wide uncertainty; the 0.25° maps repeat ~1° model information; the rainfall domain is for display and summaries only.

Monthly tercile outlooks

JJAS 2026 — May initialization · JJAS R1+R2 rainfall domain

